

Plug-in free video

HTML5 supported browsers have access to plug-in free video

Youtube IPv6

Google starts IPv6 for Youtube making it one of the first popular sites to do so

Feature

work (RBN) which is synonymous with online cyber crime. RBN takes advantages of the unused or discarded web addresses that are lying in the Deep Web. They activate these addresses for a couple of minutes, send out millions of spam email and then deactivate the address. This makes them untraceable. They also host web sites whose content relates to child porn, malware, spyware among other such cyber crimes.

Federated Search

Now that we have the information on the existence of another web, let us try to find out ways in which we can harness this repository of information. Popular search engines only crawl web sites for links but are not able to search databases. Federated search engines is a category which searches multiple online databases or web resources.

Federated search engines work with the help of software connectors. Connectors are software programs written to access a content source which can be a database. A connector apart from

knowing the URL of the source should know how to send search commands based on the search syntax of that particular source. Complexity of the connector program depends on the authentication methods, URL redirections, cookies number of steps required to access data from that source.

A federated search engine uses these connectors to return the final results from various sources to you. The results from various sources are consolidated and checked for duplication and then presented to you on a single page.

These type of search engines act as an intermediary between you and the sources of your content, such that you do not have to visit the individual web site which has the database to perform your search.

Federated search is different from Meta search, which is basically a search engine that searches more than one popular search engine at a time. The reason being that the underlying search element for popular web search is still a crawler, unlike in federated search where the search query is enabled to search the databases.

Juliana Friere, Associate Professor at the School of Computing at the University of Utah along with her team has come up with Deep Peep (www.deeppEEP.org) which aims to crawl public databases for casual as well as expert users. "DeepPeep is a vertical search engine: it is specialised in web forms – the entry points to hidden web content. Currently, we index 45,000 pages that contain forms, spanning 7 distinct domains," she said.

According to her a lot of mainstream web sites are searching the deep web to a certain extent. "Having the ability to combine visible and hidden web information in a search engine's results can lead to higher quality information being presented to users. But if not done right, this can lead to further overwhelming users with information," she added

Benefits of federated search Saves Time

Federated search engines are a boon to research students as it helps in saving on a lot of time. The federated search engine performs simultaneous searches on different databases such that the user does

not have to visit individual site to perform a search. It consolidates the results of all the various database searches onto one web page.

Quality of results

The quality of results in a federated search is much better off than a popular search engine result on the same topic. This is because the federated search gets its results from databases which are associated with particular organisations which are authorities on the subject.

Lets say for instance a medical student wants details on Stem Cell Research. Now a popular engine search will provide links to news articles or say Wikipedia which corresponds to Stem Cell Research. A federated search engine like Mednar, on the other hand will provide links to articles from government recognised health institutes. It's a no brainer, that the quality of information derived from the medical institution will be of far greater significance than say the information derived from Wikipedia.

Real time search

Federated search does real time searching such that you get the most up to date information from the source on your next query. Whereas in popular search engines, the search results are updated only when the crawlers crawl the web. Deep web search engines search each source live for all the queries that it gets. So as soon as the parent database is updated to include a new document, the next search will find it.

However the time taken for coming up with results on a federated search engine is quite high as compared to popular search engines. This is because the federated search results depend on how fast the underlying database search performs. The most common work around that most federated search engines use is to populate the results incrementally as they get the results from the underlying search engines.

So next time you log on to the web, do not just limit your search to popular search engines. Do try to explore the deep web. 

Federated search engines

www.deeppEEP.org

Deep Peep is a search engine specialised in Web forms. The current beta version currently tracks 45,000 forms across 7 domains. These domains include auto, airfare, biology, book, job and rental.

www.deepwebtech.com

Deep Web Technologies, provides federated searches for scientific and technology related search queries. It has federated search sites for particular topics like mednar for medical research; biznar for searching business related sources; worldwidescience for searching scientific content from databases across the world.

www.virtualprivatelibrary.com/

On the other hand Marcus Zillman, executive director of Virtual Private Library and a deep web expert, has developed a subject tracer information blog, which has links to research web sites divided into neat categories. This blog does not have any search query box. So you will have to decide your area of interest and then according follow the links on the virtual private library's home page.

www.pipl.com

This is an excellent site that scours the deep web for searching people based on their names, email addresses, usernames or even phone numbers.